



Save the Date!



Paws at the Pavilion

(formerly the Fall Fundraising Gala)

September 20 from 5-9 PM @ GTA Marina

\$80/person

Catered by Cucina Bella

Dancing • Silent Auction • Food • Wine

Beer • Pop

More details to come!

Free Pet Food Distributions Continue to Help People & Their Pets



Board President, Sam Smith and volunteer Carol Trebian unloading a van full of free pet food.

Since the beginning of the year, Safe Haven has given away thousands of dollars of free pet food to members of the community. This food, supplied through a partnership with Greater Good Charities in Cedar Rapids, is helping people in need keep their beloved pets in their homes. It is handed out during specific distribution events at the shelter and is also delivered to the 5 food banks that serve Jo Daviess County.

The gratefulness of the recipients has impacted many of the volunteers who participate. "As a volunteer one of the many joys I receive is giving back to the community. Some of you might not know that here at Safe Haven we donate food to all the local food pantries, Galena, Hanover, Elizabeth, Stockton, and Warren. This is something that I have recently gotten involved with. What is so wonderful about this project, is, it allows families who might be struggling to feed their pet, to keep the pet in their homes. With this help, they may not have to give them up - it keeps the pets out of the shelter," said Eric Anderson.

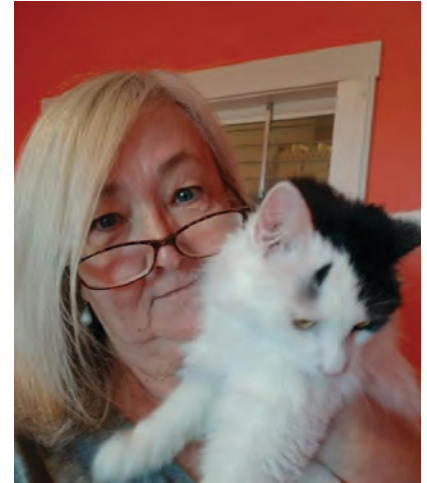
Our Amazing Team!



Jeannette Thraen McCullum
Shelter Manager



Anne Marie James
Bookkeeper



Cher Dyle
Volunteer Coordinator



Taylor Edler
Veterinary Assistant



Katie Hoffman
Shelter Assistant



Amanda Kautz
Shelter Assistant



Andrew Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Kristin Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Wendy Weimerskirk
Shelter Assistant

From the President

In the six plus years I have been affiliated with Safe Haven as a board member, the organization has changed significantly. Some of the changes have been induced by COVID-19 and the subsequent aftereffects. Safe Haven has also greatly increased its outreach to assist residents with caring for both owned pets and community cat colonies.

In the past year, the surrenders of dogs have accelerated. Many factors have influenced this trend. Some are due to the aging of owners who can no longer care for their pet, such as a move to assisted living or a nursing home. Many are due to owners moving to rentals that do not allow pets. Others result from the ever-increasing costs of caring for pets, including food and health care. At the same time, adoptions have been noticeably slower. This is a trend that is taking place nationwide. The result is increasing pressure on shelters and their employees and volunteers. Space for intake of additional dogs is very limited.

Local communities have experienced large numbers of community cat colonies, some feral. Many residents feel a moral responsibility to care for these cats, as they should. We hear stories of some residents who routinely neglect their own needs to feed these community cats. These community cats continue to breed, and the numbers continue to increase over time. The burden on sympathetic residents continues to grow, and these community cats can pose health and nuisance concerns for residents.

Safe Haven has long supported local food pantries in providing dog and cat food for distribution to those in need. The amount requested by these pantries has increased in the past 18 months, and we have continued to meet requests for assistance. In addition, in that same time Safe Haven has begun procuring pet food and other animal needs through affiliation with Great Good Charities and its outlet at Iowa Humane Alliance in Cedar Rapids. Through this arrangement, we are able to procure goods for a fraction of their retail cost (often less than 8 cents on

the dollar). In addition to helping support pantry needs, the majority of these goods are distributed to the public at no charge at the shelter. In total, Safe Haven distributed over \$45,000 worth of food to those in need in 2024. We expect to be able to provide similar amounts in 2025.

To alleviate the overpopulation of cats in our communities, Safe Haven has provided vouchers for spay/neuter to the public. As costs at local veterinary facilities have steadily increased, it became apparent that our strategy needed to change. As an initial step, we began regular transport of cats to the Madison Cat Project last fall. Beginning in January 2025, we scheduled 2 transports per month, with 20 cats in each transport. This process has placed a substantial burden on staff and volunteers, since cats must be loaded starting at 4AM on the day of transport.

In order to further reduce cat overpopulation, Safe Haven has established an in-house spay/neuter program. More details on this pilot program will be shared soon.

Thank you!

Sam

Sam Smith, Board President



2025 Golf Outing at Woodbine Bend a Great Success!



Board Member Kristle Corbett played in memory of her dad, Bill. Her son, Ezra, joined her in the cart.



Jim Riley of Riley Subaru/Dubuque, left, and team with the hole-in-one car on the course that the dealership sponsored. Riley Subaru has stepped up to become a major supporter of Safe Haven as we thank them!

The 5th Annual Golf Outing in Memory of former Safe Haven Board Chair, Bill Corbett took place on June 8th at Woodbine Bend. A total of 19 foursomes participated. We were blessed with a beautiful day after a brief rain shower.

An additional number of supporters joined us for a buffet dinner, bringing the total number of participants to 110. A variety of items were available for our silent auction, including a signed Bears

football, baseball tickets, and restaurant and goods donations from many local businesses.

This is one of Safe Haven's largest fundraisers, and this year's event was certainly a success. We are extremely thankful for our many sponsors who make this event so helpful in making the lives of residents and their companion animals better.

Safe Haven Thanks the 2025 Golf Outing Sponsors

Best Friend ~ \$2,500

Sam & Lynda Smith
Fitzgerald Family Foundation
Riley Subaru

Sassy Cat ~ \$750

AE Landscape Borders
Edward Jones - Elizabeth
FCB - First Community Bank
Grasskickers
Horsepower Farm
Sullivan Realty

Playful Pup ~ \$500

Bauer & Fonseca
Citizens State Bank
Community Bank - Warren
Dave & Debbie Kizior
Hoskins Building Center

Northern Illinois Veterinary Svcs

Northwest Illinois Eyecare
RE/MAX Prime Properties
Union-Hoermann
VFW Post 2665 Galena
Feisty Kitten ~ \$250
Andrew Chesney
Big Heart Ranch
Cheryl & Tom Stine
Coldwell Banker Network Realty
Culver's of Galena
Darin LaHood
Dr. Ralph & Mary Jo Losey

Eagle Point Solar
Elks Lodge Galena
Galena Square Veterinary
H. B. Wilkinson Title

Highway 20 Brewing Company

Jo-Carroll Energy
Main Street Realty
Midwest Animal & Pest Control
Plager, Krug, Bauer, Rudolph & Stodden Ltd
Riverboat Twilight
Sandlin Appliance
Saunders Oil
Shenandoah Riding Center
Stephenson Service Company
Steve & Mac Taylor
Tony McCombie
Veterinary Associates
Vignettes

From the Treasurer

All of Us Can Support Safe Haven's Service to the Community

Safe Haven depends 100% on donations from supporters to continue our service to the community – accepting surrendered cats and dogs, providing treatment when needed, and placing them in loving homes; supporting the spaying and neutering of pets in the community; providing pet food into our local food banks; and supporting a dog training team.

This service happens through a great staff and team of volunteers... as well as a caring Board of Directors... and, of course, through a great network of supporters within the community, who have provided us with many gifts over the years.

We are proud to say that in the past year we have enhanced our facilities to better serve you – replaced our 50-year-old roof, added solar panels to reduce our dependency on commercial electricity, improved our gutters and curbing to improve safety, and started implementation of a low-cost clinic to provide spay/neutering for our pets. These projects will improve our ability to serve you, and reduce our monthly operating expenses.

But there is more Safe Haven can do within our community, and our ability to do that is supported by you. Consider gifts or donations to Safe Haven. There are many ways you can do that:

1. Bequests: A legacy contribution can be added to your will. A legacy contribution such as this can strengthen the financial base of Safe Haven for the future, and can take the form of cash, securities, life insurance, or physical assets such as real estate.

2. Qualified Charitable Distribution (QCD): QCD's are an option for taxpayers over age 70 ½ that allows them to make a donation to a qualified non-profit, 501(c)(3), with a tax free withdrawal

from their retirement account. QCD's are especially advantageous after age 73, when a QCD can apply to the Required Minimum Distribution (RMD), and eliminate the income tax on that portion of the RMD.

3. Memorials: Safe Haven can be the beneficiary of a gift or memorial at the time of one's passing if designated by the survivor's family members.

4. Christmas Appeal: Consider a gift to Safe Haven during the holiday season as part of your year-end giving.

5. Membership Dues & Pet Sponsorships: Donations to Safe Haven can be made monthly or yearly through our website (savehavenforpets.org) or through our Facebook Page.

6. Golf Outing, Gala & Birdies for Charity: Consider participating in our seasonal events, or consider sponsorship or silent auction items for these events.

Thank You!

Dave

Dave Kizior, Board Treasurer



Some of Our Amazing Volunteers in Action!



Volunteers Jane VanHamme, left, and Jane Bechaka joined Board President Sam Smith at *Pawstravaganza*, a celebration of pets sponsored by Riley Subaru in Dubuque.



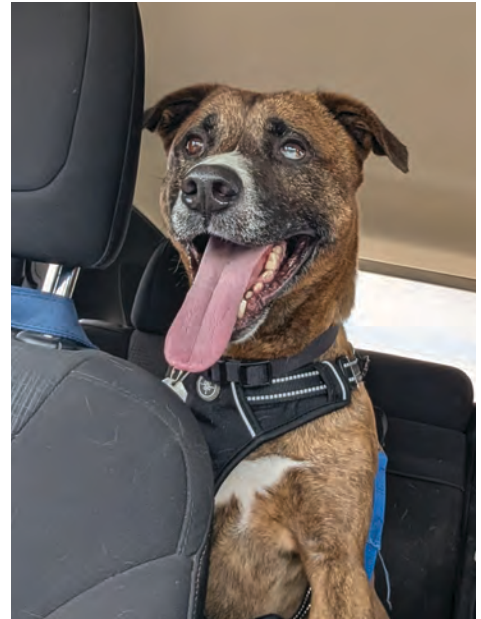
Karla Rolwes and Safe Haven's Sammy did a great job representing Safe Haven during the Village of Elizabeth's annual *Spring Fling*.



Prior to the start of the in-house spay/neuter clinic, Safe Haven began to address the feral cat issue in our area by utilizing low cost services at the Madison Cat Project in Madison, WI. This involved a lengthy set up and take down of cat crates the day before and the day of transport, as well as an early morning start to get to the clinic on time. Volunteers Krista and Amsen, shown, and Curt and Sara stepped up to help by driving the Safe Haven van, filled with local cats, to and from Madison! They had such a good time that they all volunteered to make another trip.



Former Board President, Trish Bianchetta, completed another semester teaching the *Kind-hearted Kids 2 by 2 Character Development Program* to Scales Mound 2nd graders this spring. Kind-hearted kids features 10 lessons in which kids learn life-long skills around self and social awareness, self-management and good decision-making along with the core values of kindness, respect, responsibility, empathy, and citizenship through caring for a stuffed animal. Trish introduced this program to River Ridge and Scales Mound schools in 2018.



Several of our volunteers make our shelter dog's days extra special by taking them for a ride in their cars! For those dogs that like car rides, this extra bit of enrichment brings smiles to all!



Safe Haven is thrilled to welcome the Shooting Stars 4H of Elizabeth as volunteers to the shelter. The group has been helping with garden maintenance and other yard work that staff has a hard time getting to. They are keeping the shelter landscaping looking great for everyone coming to Safe Haven and we thank them.



Volunteer Norm taking care of business around the dog yards in the back of the shelter. Notice the brand new sidewalk he is standing on? This area was impossible to keep shoveled during the winter and was a muddy mess after a rain. The new walks will make it so much easier for volunteers to take the dogs out for some exercise.



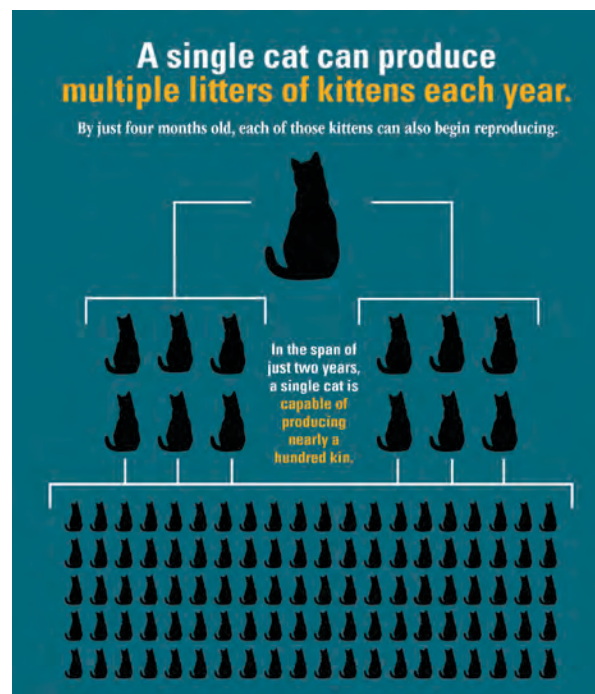
Ronan the golden retriever has become our first "AmbassaDog", raising money for the us during community events. "Ronan loves to greet Galena's visitors everywhere we go, so with Safe Haven's permission he started to wear a donation collection vest when we're out and about," said dog-mom, Rachel. In his role as spokes-dog, Ronan has rased over \$150 in cash!

Low Cost Spay/Neuter Pilot Program Begins

Safe Haven began as a group of volunteers feeding stray cats nearly 30 years ago. The desire to address the feral cat over-population in Jo Daviess County has stayed with the organization ever since. To that end, Safe Haven conducted its first low cost spay/neuter day on June 14th. This clinic was established with funds donated by Gary and Cammy Seamans. Initial operating funds were donated by Nancy Willett and Marie Wright.

In order to allow sufficient time to allow training, we limited this initial session to a dozen cats. The clinic was staffed by Dr. Dulce Coulson, a veterinary technician, and a cadre of volunteers. Much of the day was spent educating volunteers on various roles needed to carry out duties effectively. The whole process flowed very smoothly by the end of the day.

Over time, we will up the number of cats treated per session as volunteers and staff gain experience with the process. Stay tuned as we gear up to shrink the feral cat colonies in our region in a truly impactful way.



Graphic (c) SPCA of Wake County, Raleigh, NC.

Sponsor-A-Pet - Starts at Just \$10/Month!

Your monthly donation of \$10 or more helps to support one of our cats or dogs in the shelter. We accept credit cards and automatically charge your donation every month. You may terminate the charges at any time by notifying us. Please consider joining those who make these contributions by signing up at www.safehavenforpets.org and scroll down to the bottom of the homepage. A sincere thank you to all of our generous supporters!

David Anderson
Stephanie Beardsley
Kathleen Behof
Nancy Buening
Steve & Trish Bianchetta
Gary Binder
Mary & Brian Brandt
August Comella
Dan & Connie Consedine
Juanita Cox
John & Kay Day
Divine Interventions
Cathy Dorwick
Bob & Lu Douglas

Edith Duncan
Linda & Wilfred Enders
Andrea Garvey
David Gilliland
Larry & Karen Gorczowski
Bernie & Mary Carol Harris
Debra Huso
Nancy Hyman
Barb Jansz
Richard & Karen Jasper
Lucy Koropchuk
Pat & Linda Malia
Brittany & Dave Middendorf
Julie & Jerry Moore

Joseph Murnane
Tom & Wallene Neumiller
Donna Pries
James & Ulrike Rachuy
Helen Reed
Sam & Lynda Smith
The Freckles Foundation/Jeni Pearce
Doug Troutman
John & Lisa Wilhelmsen
Lisa Bourrette
Steve Efken

“Continue to do the Lord’s Work”

These words have been communicated to us several times by the principal of our great financial supporter, the Gary F. and Camille E. Seamans Foundation. They recently financed the startup of the low-cost spay/neuter clinic described in another article in this issue. Our manager, Jeannette McCullum, and the Board of Directors feel this is a very significant addition to the services Safe Haven provides to local communities.

We generally include feel-good articles about animals who have been adopted and the people who have given them great homes. However, the fact is that we are currently struggling to find homes for very adoptable pets. The requests to relinquish pets in homes and community cats are at an all-time high. This situation is repeated throughout the country.

We recognize that no short-term solution exists. The low-cost spay/neuter clinic will play a very important part in reducing cat overpopulation in

our communities. We will be providing basic vaccinations as well at a very low cost. Inevitably, we will have to finance many of these surgeries and vaccinations through donations from our supporters.

In order to ease the financial burden on pet owners, we have established a robust system of providing pet food through local food pantries and direct distribution from the shelter. This is designed to keep pets in their homes, with the owners who love and care for them.

There is much more to do, and we need the help of everyone who is able to help and has a love for God’s beautiful creatures. If you are not currently a financial supporter, please review the article by our Treasurer, Dave Kizior. If you are a current supporter and have the ability to do more, please consider increasing your support. No donation is too small to make a difference in the life of dogs and cats in our communities.

Please know that Safe Haven will continue to do the Lord’s work to the very best of our ability.

~ Sam Smith, President

Adoption Update

2024 Adoptions

Cats: 65

Dogs: 54

2025 Adoptions

January-June:

Cats: 39

Dogs: 11

Volunteer Update

Total volunteer hours

January-June:

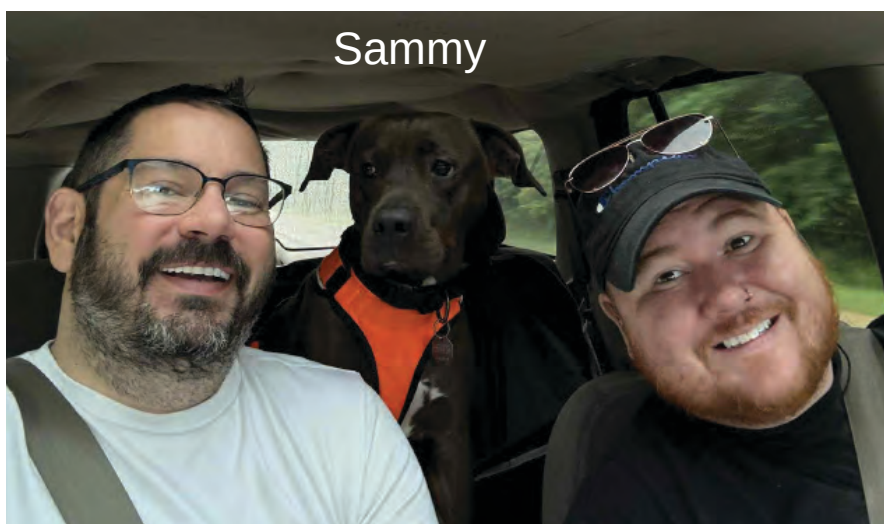
1,572

Month with the most hours:

June/391 hours

Average # of volunteers per month: **55**

A Few of Our Happy Tails



Gifts Given In Memory Of

*Thor, beloved German Shepherd
of Lauri and Chuck Follett*
Mittie Den Herder

Sue McKee
Jeffrey & Joann Eden
Donald & Angela McKenzie

Angel, our beloved dog
Paula Havranek

*Jake, beloved friend of Terry &
Lucy*
Mary Owen

Zoey
Allen Stafanick

Doris Trader
Steve & Wendy Meyer

Zane
Marv & Linda Stewart

Mikey & Max
Diane & Stacie O'Dell

Teddy Bear
Eugene Champion

Frieda Kochman
Shari Kochman

Bella Teske
Shawn & Milena Teske

Emmett & Ace
Connie Kaderly

*Our cat Dewey, adopted from
Safe Haven in 2010*
Paul & Judy Chiarelli

Dan Prather
Marci Prather

Robert Zink
Sheila Zink

George W Bookless, Jr
Kathy Bookless

Baron – our sweet Rottweiler
Dianne Allendorf
Ginger

Lyle Heinkel

Simone Winter
Becky Cahill

Sharon Tranel
Colleen Dempsey

Tara, Buddy, & Garfield
Edith Duncan

Vince Vesely
Judith L. Vesely

Valda & Delmar Groezinger
Arlene Groezinger

*All my beloved pets who have
gone to God's Home*
Pastor Carole Andres

Tom Arand
Leonard Arand

Gus
Mary Kay & Bill Holmes

Anne Martin
Joe & Joan Offerman

Timothy C. Baird
Barbara Baird

*My wonderful Cousin Luanne
Sullivan*
Amy Butzow

Mario Gonzales
Tom & Wallene Neumiller

Cookie
Nancy Backe

Kathleen Furlong
Stewart & Jane Johnson

Deanna Smith
Anonymous

*Nana & Beba, who loved their
pets dearly*
Carlee Redfearn

Aramis, our tabby cat
Colin & Flavia Farinha

Petula Belle
Candice LeBowe

Thea O'Connor
William & Pamela O'Connor

Gouda & Rosco
Greg & Gloria Christ

Meg & Lady, Safe Haven Alumni
Nancy Peterson & David Becker

St Bernard Moe & JT the Kitty
Mark VanOsdol

Susan Loring
Terry Loring

Dink
John & Linda Malia

Teddy Bear
Eugene Champion

KaBoom Morettin
Cindy Morettin

Mimi
Charlene & Garnet Fee

Dr. Willy Enders
Janice Kuehl

Arlene O'Callaghan
Jack O'Callaghan

*Sweet Abbie, Adopted from
Safe Haven in 2014*
Judy Bauer

Steve Allendorf
The Jo Daviess County Board

Rosie & Henry, My BFFs
Susan Settler

Hamilton "Hammy"
Beardsley-Schulz
Abby Scanlon

Our friend Rita Cook
Greg & Laurie Starrett

Judy Atkinson
Kari Strang

Rita Kay Cook
Raymie & Tracy Diestelmeier
Timothy & Colleen Ward
Judith Williams
Donna & Jerry Virtue

Lucy Larson
Donna Pouzar

Lynn Bourrette
Sheree Johnson

*Freya, my little Tabby adopted
from Safe Haven*
Ingrid Tarolla

*Abbie Ruth, Formerly Ruthie –
Adopted 2/14/14 from Safe Haven*
Michael & Judith Bauer

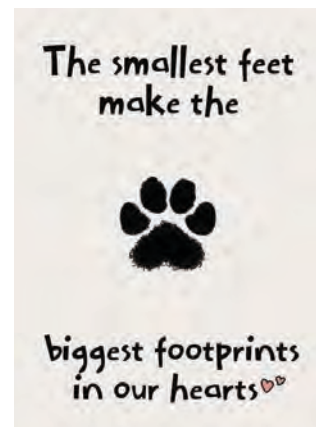
Betty Jo Zelasco
Sam & Lynda Smith
Jeannette Thraen

Elsie Hots
Robert Heuerman

Marilyn, Deb Kelly's Basset Hound
Susan & Steven Barg

*Joli, beloved dog of the Nimocks
Family*
*Seven, beloved cat of Alaina
Nimocks*
Mittie Nimocks Den Herder

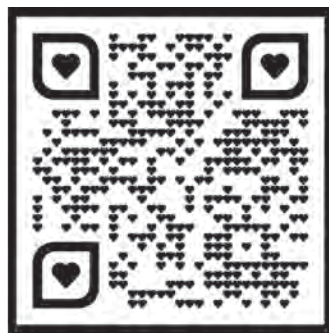
Russell Samec
Michael Samec



We try very hard to ensure that our in memory of and in honor of donations are included correctly in our newsletter. If you made a donation and it was not included or it was misspelled, please send an email to safehavenbookkeeper1471@gmail.com and we will make sure it is corrected in our next newsletter.



Safe Haven
 1471 U.S. Highway 20
 Elizabeth, IL 61028
 815.858.2265
www.safehavenforpets.org
safehaven1471@gmail.com



Gifts Given In Honor Of

Layla, Adopted from Safe Haven 2022
 Ronn Lasiter

Smokie & Lacy
 Jack G. Woodard

Billy the cat with Jameson & Grandpa
 Steve & Joan Efken

Sylvester & Luna Duerr, known as Barley &
 River at Safe Haven
 Laura & John Duerr

Shadow Bandit
 Lyle Heinkel

Max Richter and Nicole Battiste
 Kelly Richter

Kevin McCullum's Birthday
 Irle & Marilyn Boehm

Carol Scarpelli's Birthday
 Biddy Ramstedt
 Sharon Lehner
 Mark Scarpelli

Our Scooter
 Willard & Patricia Meyer

Kristle Corbett, Pet Sitter Extraordinaire
 Linda Robinson (Lexi & Gina)

Lily & Parker
 Ken & Marcia Thompson

Barb & Tom Jansz
 Denise Ertzman
 Chris Rauscher

Bob Horbach
 Joe & Joan Offerman

Riley
 Jeanne Wilcoxon

Janet Bakes Birthday
 Stacey Smith

The Bianchetta Family
 Kristen Diaz

Billy Bob, adopted as Ajax
 Joyce Coulthard

Bob & Heidi Dittmar
 Anonymous

Lucy
 Jim & Missy Boho

Junior volunteer Jamison, recognizing all
 the work he does & the help he provided to
 get the cat his grandfather adopted ready
 to be in a new home
 Jane Hess

Christine Baker's Birthday
 Matt Zaucha

-
 Dan & Peggy Korth, Stockton, IL
 Laura & Doug Dufford
 Jana Frohlich
 Yolanda Lobacz

Lily, Adopted from Safe Haven
 9 years ago
 Marcia Thompson

Kitty Behof
 John & Suzanne Bernardi

Jackie Buckley's 80th Birthday
 Al & Carol Zarnstorff

Our son Mick's 55th Birthday and
 his cat Jack
 Sam & Lynda Smith